OFFICIAL DEPLOYMENT & BUSINESS BLUEPRINT

The Complete A-to-Z Guide to Hosting Your Cake Business on Vercel

A step-by-step master guide for bespoke cake bakers and patisserie owners. Learn how to preview locally, configure instant WhatsApp orders, deploy to Vercel for 100% free forever, and link your custom domain.

> 🎂 **Zero Technical Experience Required**
>
> This guide is written specifically for bakery owners. Follow the steps exactly as written, and your website will be live worldwide in under 10 minutes with zero monthly server costs!

WEBSITE PLATFORM

Velvet & Bloom Cake Studio

HOSTING PROVIDER

Vercel Cloud (Hobby Tier - Free)

LEAD GENERATOR

Direct WhatsApp Order Integration

AUTHOR & ARCHITECT

Antigravity Engineering

CHAPTER 1

Overview & What You Have Received

Congratulations on taking your cake business online! You have been provided with an ultra-fast, luxury-styled web application designed specifically for bespoke custom cake bakers, wedding cake designers, and pastry artists.

Key Files in Your Website Folder:

File / Folder	What It Does	Do You Need to Edit It?
`index.html`	The main web page container that holds your entire shop layout and SEO tags.	Rarely (already pre-configured)
`js/data/config.js`	Stores your Bakery Name, WhatsApp number, currency symbol, and studio hours.	**YES (Takes 2 minutes)**
`js/data/cakes.js`	Contains your cake catalog, flavors, serving counts, descriptions, and prices.	Optional (Edit when updating menu)
`assets/images/`	High-resolution photos of wedding cakes, birthday cakes, bento boxes, and cupcakes.	Replace with your own cake photos anytime
`vercel.json`	Cloud hosting rules for Vercel ensuring lightning-fast global caching and security.	No (Ready out of the box)
`start.bat`	1-Click Windows shortcut to instantly test and run the website on your PC.	No (Just double-click to run!)

> 💡 **Why Pure Modern HTML/CSS/JS is Best for Your Bakery:**
> Unlike heavy platforms that crash, require monthly maintenance fees, or have complicated build steps, this site uses clean, standard web technology. It has **zero monthly hosting fees**, loads in under 1 second, and will never break when hosting on Vercel!

CHAPTER 2

Testing & Previewing Locally on Windows

Before deploying to the internet, you can view and test your website right on your Windows computer with a single click.

1 Method A: The 1-Click Windows Launcher (Easiest)

1. Open the folder where your website files are saved.
2. Find the file named `start.bat`.
3. Double-click `start.bat`.
4. A small black window will appear running your local server, and your default web browser (Chrome or Edge) will automatically open:

```
http://localhost:8080/
```

5. You can now browse the site, test the Cake Builder, add items to the bag, and test WhatsApp buttons!

2 Method B: PowerShell Web Server

If you prefer PowerShell, open PowerShell inside the folder and run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\serve.ps1 -Port 8080
```

Then open Google Chrome and navigate to `http://localhost:8080/`.

3 How to Stop the Server

When you are done testing, simply press `Ctrl + C` in the terminal window, or close the window.

CHAPTER 3

Customizing Your Bakery Info in 3 Minutes

All business details are stored in one single, friendly file: `js/data/config.js`. You do NOT need coding skills to change them.

1 Open `js/data/config.js` in Notepad or VS Code

You will see clear settings like this:

```
export const SHOP_CONFIG = {
  name: "Velvet & Bloom",                      // Put your Bakery Name here
  subtitle: "Artisan Cake Studio & Patisserie", // Your tagline
  phone: "+1 (555) 748-CAKE",                  // Display phone number
  whatsappNumber: "15557482253",               // YOUR WHATSAPP NUMBER (Important!)
  currencySymbol: "$",                          // Change to £, €, ₹, AED, etc.
  leadTimeDays: 3,                              // Days notice required
  location: "428 Artisan Lane, Blossom District"// Your city/studio address
};
```

> ⚠️ **How to Format Your WhatsApp Number:**
>
> In `whatsappNumber`, enter your full mobile number with country code, but with **no plus sign (+), no spaces, and no hyphens**.
> *Example for US:* `14155552671`
> *Example for UK:* `447911123456`
> *Example for India:* `919876543210`
> When a customer clicks "Order via WhatsApp", their phone will immediately open a chat with this number!

CHAPTER 4

Creating a Free GitHub Account & Repository

Vercel connects directly to GitHub. This means whenever you change a price or add a new photo on GitHub, Vercel updates your live website automatically!

1 Step 4.1: Sign Up for GitHub

1. Visit **https://github.com** in your browser.
2. Click **Sign up**. Enter your email, create a password, and verify your account. GitHub is 100% free.

2 Step 4.2: Create a New Repository

1. In GitHub, click the **+** icon in the top right corner and choose **New repository**.
2. **Repository name:** Enter something like `my-cake-website`.
3. Set visibility to **Public** or **Private** (both work on Vercel).
4. Leave "Add a README file" unchecked.
5. Click the green **Create repository** button.

3 Step 4.3: Upload Your Website Files

Option A (Browser Web Upload - No Git Required):
On your new repository page, click the link that says **"uploading an existing file"**. Select all the files and folders from your website project (`index.html` , `vercel.json` , `css/` , `js/` , `assets/`) and drag them into the browser. Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.

Option B (Using Git command line if installed):

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Launch Cake Studio Website"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/my-cake-website.git
git push -u origin main
```

CHAPTER 5

Deploying to Vercel in 60 Seconds (Free Forever)

Vercel is the world's leading cloud hosting platform for modern web apps. Their "Hobby" tier is completely free, includes lightning-fast global CDN, and gives you free SSL (https://).

1 Step 5.1: Create a Free Vercel Account

1. Go to **https://vercel.com/signup**.
2. Choose **"Continue with GitHub"**. This automatically links your accounts.
3. Select **Hobby (Personal Account)**.

2 Step 5.2: Import Your Repository

1. On your Vercel Dashboard, click the blue button that says **"Add New..."** → **"Project"**.
2. Under "Import Git Repository", you will see your `my-cake-website` repository.
3. Click the **"Import"** button next to it.

3 Step 5.3: Project Configuration (Zero Setup Needed!)

Vercel will show the project configuration screen:

- ✓ **Project Name:** You can keep it as `my-cake-website` or give it your bakery's name.
- ✓ **Framework Preset:** Select **"Other"**.
- ✓ **Root Directory:** Leave as `./`.
- ✓ **Build Command:** Leave blank (not needed for pure HTML/JS).
- ✓ **Output Directory:** Leave blank.

4 Step 5.4: Click Deploy & Celebrate! 🚀

Click the green **"Deploy"** button. Within 15 to 30 seconds, confetti will burst on screen with a message saying **"Congratulations!"**.
Vercel will give you a live URL, like:

```
https://my-cake-website.vercel.app
```

Your website is now officially live on the internet, accessible to anyone on phones, laptops, and tablets!

CHAPTER 6

Connecting Your Own Custom Domain Name

Want your website to look 100% professional with your own domain like `www.yourcakeshop.com`? Vercel lets you connect custom domains for free.

1 Step 6.1: Buy Your Domain (If You Don't Have One)

You can purchase a domain name for $10–$15 per year from popular registrars such as **Namecheap**, **GoDaddy**, **Google Domains (Squarespace)**, or **Cloudflare**.

2 Step 6.2: Add Domain in Vercel

1. Open your project on Vercel.
2. Click on the **Settings** tab at the top.
3. In the left sidebar, click **Domains**.
4. In the text box, type your domain (e.g. `yourcakeshop.com`) and click **Add**.

3 Step 6.3: Update Your DNS Records

Log in to where you bought your domain (e.g. Namecheap or GoDaddy), go to the **DNS Settings** or **Manage DNS** area, and add these two simple records provided by Vercel:

Type	Name / Host	Value / Destination	TTL
A Record	`@` (or blank)	`76.76.21.21`	Automatic (or 3600)
CNAME	`www`	`cname.vercel-dns.com`	Automatic (or 3600)

Once saved, Vercel will verify the records within a few minutes, generate an automatic free SSL security certificate, and your custom domain will be active!

CHAPTER 7

Managing Cake Orders & The Baker Console

How do orders work once your website is live? Your platform includes two seamless ways to receive and track cake bookings:

1. The Instant WhatsApp Flow (Best for Closing Sales Fast)

When a customer builds a custom cake or checks out their shopping bag, they can click **"Order via WhatsApp"**. This generates a beautifully formatted message sent straight to your phone:

```
🍰 NEW CAKE ORDER / INQUIRY - Velvet & Bloom
━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━
🎂 CUSTOM BESPOKE CAKE ORDER:
• Occasion: Birthday Milestone
• Size/Servings: 6" Tall (12-16 portions)
• Base Sponge: Madagascar Vanilla Bean & Berry
• Filling: Whipped White Chocolate Ganache
• Design Style: Modern Pastel Drip & Macarons
• Dietary: 100% Pure Eggless
• Date of Event: 2026-09-28
• Cake Inscription: "Happy 30th Birthday Rachel!"
• Fulfillment: STUDIO PICKUP
💰 Estimated Total: $115
━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━━
```

You can immediately reply with your payment details (e.g. "Hi Rachel! We'd love to bake this for you. To confirm your date, please send a 50% deposit to...") and close the sale in seconds!

2. The Baker's Production Console

In your website's top navigation bar, click **" 👩‍🍳 Baker Console"**:

- ✓ **Production Schedule:** See all upcoming booked celebration dates in order.
- ✓ **Status Tracker:** Move orders from *New Inquiry* → *Baking Scheduled* → *Decorating* → *Ready for Pickup*.
- ✓ **Add Phone Orders:** Take orders over the phone or in person? Click "+ Add Phone Order" to keep all your bookings in one synchronized place.
- ✓ **Client Notes:** Instant access to cake inscriptions, dietary notes, and customer numbers.

CHAPTER 8

Bakery Marketing & Local SEO Checklist

Now that your website is online, here are 5 actionable steps to start receiving orders immediately from people celebrating birthdays and weddings in your city:

1 Claim Your Free Google Business Profile

Go to **google.com/business** and create a free profile for your cake bakery. Put your new website URL in the profile. When local clients search "custom birthday cake near me" or "wedding cakes in [your city]", Google will show your shop on Google Maps!

2 Put Your Website Link in Your Instagram Bio

Add your live Vercel/custom domain URL to your Instagram, TikTok, and Facebook bio. Add a call to action: *"Design your custom celebration cake & get an instant quote on our website 🍰👇"*.

3 Post "Cross-Section / Cake Slicing" Reels

Videos showing a sharp warm knife slicing through tender sponge layers with oozing ganache or fruit coulis get millions of organic views on TikTok and Instagram Reels. Always link back to your Cake Builder!

4 Offer Wedding Tasting Boxes

For brides and grooms planning their wedding, offer your 6-cupcake tasting box. When they taste the real Madagascar vanilla and Belgian chocolate in person, your booking rate will skyrocket.

> 🎉 **You Are All Set for Sweet Success!**
>
> Your website is fast, mobile-friendly, beautiful, and costs $0/month on Vercel. Keep baking amazing cakes, delighting clients, and creating unforgettable memories!